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CHRISTMAS LECTURE 1975

Greetings, my beloved ones. The blessings flow richly from your innermost being into the outer world and from the outer world around you back into your innermost being. The birth of Christ celebrates and symbolizes birth, not only birth of an entity, of a human being, but birth of new expressions, of new ways of expressing God in life, birth of new levels of consciousness. The celebration of birth always follows the celebration of what you experience as death. It is an endless chain, a continuum of consciousness, but each birth always gives rise to new joy. And death is nothing else but another form of birth. It simply is the reverse side, symbolized in your religious history by Easter, where resurrection follows death.

At one time in your history, birth had to be celebrated and symbolized in the appearance of a human being. At that time in history, man's consciousness was still very much on an outer level. Everything had to be outward. Now there was a man of such purity that the Christ could manifest in a totality seldom, if ever, experienced to that degree on the plane of matter.

However, it is a misunderstanding to assume that the new coming of the Christ will take form in the same manner. The Christ lives within everyone and within everything that breathes and has consciousness. The Christ has been given birth by your work, my beloved friends. At each step of your path where you find a misconception, a negativity, a block, a destructiveness, a problem, an ignorance, you find a direct obstruction to the Christ within. In the new age, the energy, the impetus, the power of the Christ has newly risen. It is not a sentimental meek force by any means. It has tremendous power. Its strength sweeps your earth sphere, and those of you who are ready and have the courage, the inner courage, to make room for joy, for pleasure, to make room for ecstasy can experience the Christ within. You can give birth to the Christ in you. At the same time, this joy, this ecstasy, this total peace cannot be experienced unless you purify your soul, for otherwise you become anxious and contracted in a negative way, and you reject the experience of joy and ecstasy. You cannot bear it. You create circumstances around you that seem to justify misery and darkness, but you must court that misery and darkness. To the degree you refuse purification, you lack the courage to change into better ways, into new ways, into the ways within you that come with a powerful sweep. They show you that life is good. You can afford generosity. You can afford to let others be their best. You can afford to give up the little self-interests. You can afford to be in a state of love. You can afford to have the courage and to risk truth. You can afford humility, and the best will flow to you because you can receive it.

Your offerings, symbolized in the ornaments on your tree, are very real. These offerings must often be repeated, perhaps in your daily meditation, in your work sessions, in your group experiences, in your interaction with one another. They can be renewed when one points out to another what he or she observes and when you listen more with an ear to what is the truth rather

than "I am being rejected and hurt and misjudged." When you listen for the truth, you will find the Christ within. You will experience the greater life, the real life that you are so much more part of, your greater being, your eternal reality. You will know there is nothing to fear and nothing to mourn.

You, my friends, who are carriers and instruments in this important historical time at this point of evolution, actually live simultaneously in two worlds. In your consciousness, you start off believing only in this world that is very real to you. And it is indeed important, for it is your task to infuse the world of matter with the greater spiritual reality in which you are much more firmly planted than you realize. Only the separated consciousness manages not to know this, but as you progress on your path slowly but surely, your mind enlarges, your mind makes a leap, and suddenly you find there is another consciousness that is so much more real. Perhaps you discover it first by creating a channel, as you call it. More and more of you begin to create this channel and thus find out who you really are. What greater gift could you give to yourself than making an effort to create this channel to that in you which is the Christ? The Christ in you is your true identity which knows all and fears nothing and lives forever. It is that you that is always bathed in light, that is a light body, an energy body, truly indestructible.

Your consciousness has its feet planted in both these worlds, and that is your task: to bring the world that is the reality into the outer realms and so to infuse the light of the newly born Christ into matter. Christ is born every minute, every second in time. Every new realization, every spurt of new consciousness, every breath of love, every change of attitude gives birth to the Christ, until all these many little lights that you light up in your own souls, spreading into others' souls, converge and emerge into one huge sea of light, into a sea of love, into a sea of intense joyous awareness.

Your community grows in depth, in beauty, in truth, in love, and in abundance, and so more and more you make room for the Christ to guide you, to infuse you, to protect you, and to love you. And you discover a new oneness with each other although you had started off as strangers with walls around you. But these walls begin to crumble, and what was illusory separation turns out to be what it always was and really is, a oneness of consciousness, a love between various aspects of God. Each one of you is a beautiful aspect and individualization of God. And you learn to discover this and not to diminish your personality but rather to make a bridge, a beautiful golden bridge from one to the other. This message, my beloved ones, will bring you into your inner being and perhaps create a greater awareness of it than you have ever had. You can translate these words into your own new awareness of your true identity and discover your eternal reality, your eternal love and beauty and safety, for you need not fear or guard against anyone or anything.

And now, my dear ones, I am ready for your questions.

QUESTION: A group of us who work with children on the path as helpers have started what we call a children's seminar where we discuss the problems of working with children. One of the subjects of discussion for our next meeting is sexuality in children. I wondered if you could address the children tonight on this subject and help us who work with the children.

ANSWER: It is of course a wonderful thing that the old taboos are removed. The old restrictions that make sexuality a dirty guilty secret no longer exist. It is important that a growing human being knows and learns to accept this beautiful force, this divine force. At the same time, it

is of equal importance to realize that the greater a force is, whether it be the force of sexuality or any other spiritual force (and there are many), the more it requires a tremendous amount of maturity (and young people can be mature) which means a sense of responsibility and self-discipline. Self-discipline here is not meant in the sense of denial of pleasure, but in the sense of the constant process of self-purification, of honesty, of truthfulness, of commitment to growing. If this deep sincere commitment to self-discipline is lacking, the sexual force cannot be borne and will turn into destructiveness. It is important to understand this. It is also important to realize that without a loving heart sexuality becomes shallow, unfulfilling, empty, and it will always be guilt-producing, no matter what the mores of your outer society may be. The guilt is then an inner guilt for wanting to grab a pleasure in a selfish way without lovingness. Only when that attitude of lovingness is cultivated can guiltlessness exist and therefore the full capacity to enjoy all the pleasures, including sexual pleasure.

QUESTION: I want to know why I hurry through life.

ANSWER: You hurry through life because you want to shut out your anxieties and fears, my son. And you need not do so. You have people around you who will help you to feel and explore your anxieties. The anxiety you produce by denying your anxiety is much greater than the original anxiety. So my suggestion is: when you wish to rush, hold still and allow yourself to feel your fears, your worries, your negative thoughts, and express them to your helper. Discuss them in your helper sessions and with your path friends who have more experience to guide you. This will free you of these anxieties so that you can be calm. It is wonderful that you have asked this question.

QUESTION: My daughter is in a very low energy level, especially in the morning. It is very difficult for her to move in the morning. I know there is a characterological reason for this, but I would like to know if there is anything I can do about it and what is the deeper meaning of this problem?

ANSWER: The meaning is that she uses a great deal of energy in an artificially stirred up way. There is a lot of sexual energy there that she does not know how to handle and that creates an overagitation and that is then pushed into an overactivity that is not quite organic or harmonious, so that then an imbalance is created and at certain times energy is lacking. Now, you may not be able to immediately do something about this. At the same time your understanding, simply your awareness of this, may already have an effect on another level of reality.

QUESTION: I find that I am filled with distrust and suspicion and fear, and it manifests in paralyzing my own creations and ability to work and to pull things together economically in my personal life. I wondered if you could help me?

ANSWER: This first early stage on your path is the most difficult struggle. The further you go, the easier it becomes. But in this first phase you find it difficult to remove your mask self and look at your lower self without losing sight that you also have a higher self. Yet this higher self must not be confused with the mask self you have identified with for a long time. You had confused this mask self with your higher self. Now to remove the mask self is complicated, for if you only focus on the lower self, you despair. At the same time, if you revert back into your mask self, then you are right back where you started from. Your despair is that you cannot differentiate between the mask self and the real higher self, and that you believe that if the mask self is taken from you, you are

going to disintegrate into an evil person. Now, the lower self is there. It is never beautiful. It cannot be, it is a distortion of the beauty. However, you need to pray for the courage and the strength and the faith to go through this so that you will find the real higher self, not the false version of it. In this initial struggle, my suggestion is to make yourself available to all the help here for you. Give yourself to every aspect the pathwork offers you, and you will come through. You need also the meditational assistance to make full commitment to the courage and the trust to give birth to the Christ in you because you go through your lower self and do not evade it in wishful thinking. Your distrust is an outpicturing of your inner lack of trust that there is a real higher self in you. Your distrust is that you know deep down that your mask self is not genuine and you project that lack of genuineness onto the world outside. For it is a human being's weakness to always believe of others what they feel about themselves. One cannot suppose that others are different. You can go over these hurdles, and if you really want to, you can make it.

QUESTION: I feel also that I strongly mistrust my higher self, and even to ask for help from you is very difficult for me because there is a part in myself that persists in wanting to doubt and wanting not only to mistrust but really prove the unreality of beauty. And I want very much to take the step and ask for your help.

ANSWER: Open your heart and the blessing that is here will flow into it. Speak the words, "I want to give up my negation. I want to see the truth of the God within." Say these words. So it will be, it must be, for that is your destiny, that is your true nature. The other is but a temporary bad dream, but a dream with a deep purpose and meaning, a dream that is a task. Your earthly lives are dreams that are tasks.

QUESTION: I would like to ask your guidance on our crisis intervention program. We have tried to follow your suggestions as closely as possible. But as far as I am concerned there are two kinds of attitudes: one that is overcautious and examines everything and kills spontaneity, and the other which gives in with a carelessness rather than a trust in the spontaneous growth. And I find that when we discuss individual cases, we get caught in this type of dilemma.

ANSWER: I would make the following suggestion here. When the person who is in a crisis asks for the help, then the difficulties will be relatively small. When the person refuses to acknowledge his state of crisis, it should not be forced upon him. At the same time, it would be important to tell the person, "We think you are in crisis. We are willing to give you help, if you wish it. If you do not wish it, it is your responsibility." And let it go at that. Now, as to the people who are open for it and request it, you have so far always seen that it was very helpful and very effective. The only thing I might suggest is, that when you get entangled in these contradictory currents, you immediately let go and flow together in your inner focusing to your inner channels, to the guidance of the will of God, and it will come. You will find the right balance between giving, outgoing, and moving, between spontaneity and cautiousness. You will find the right balance. At times, discuss the problems with the person who is in need of help, without necessarily making it a helper session. And at other times simply be there with love and prayer and companionship. No rules exist. Only the intuitive connection will be valid and reliable. And that will come through prayer.

QUESTION: I find myself in a state of being very aware of how my judgments hurt me and poison my life. Yet I can't seem to stop these judgments from coming up all the time. I'm wondering if perhaps you could help me.

ANSWER: When you observe yourself in this state, just hold still and question yourself, "What would happen if I gave up the judging?" Experiment with it. You will discover various states. For example, a black hole of nothingness to begin with, which you fear -- something you cannot name or label or pin on anything. That is the creative emptiness you have to go into, out of which the true feelings will emerge. Your negative feelings, fear on a more superficial level, are a coverup of that empty black hole, or what seems to be such. You need to have the courage to go there and learn to trust it, let yourself be with it in order to get to know the real you.

My dearest friends, this is what I have to give you tonight. There will be many, many more opportunities where you can all come and ask your questions and receive my help and guidance.

Let us close with a deep focusing all together on the One, the one power that motivates, the one life that you are an expression of, the one love that colors everything into radiant beauty, the one peace that surpasses all understanding, the one joy that vibrates and resonates through the pores of the universe that you are a part of. Continue your tasks of self-purification, thus spreading this great light, and being carriers of the Christ. The love that envelopes the universe, that permeates the universe can be borne by your purified souls. You become acclimatized to do so. Let this love surge through you, and be one with it. Be your God. Be the Christ.

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